

genius

Into the toy planets **3**

For Apple II+, IIe, IIc, IIGs



by Daniele Liverani



LIVEARCADE

GENIUS

Ep.3 Into The Toy Planets

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INTRODUCTION

Genius is an arcade action game developed for the Apple II family of computers: Apple II+, IIe, IIfx and IIGS. The minimum requirements are 48k of RAM and a floppy disk drive.

The game includes sound and music. If you have a Mockingboard (or other compatible sound card), additional music is provided during game play.

To start the game just insert your diskette into the disk drive, turn on your Apple and choose between keyboard or joystick by pressing the SPACE or J key.

BACKSTORY

The main character is GENIUS, a young and clever drummer who accidentally finds a secret passage to the world of dreams and discovers what's behind the dream-creation process. He finds himself in an alternative world where he discovers that dreams are created and conducted by entities called Twinspirits, spiritual guides who allow fantasies to flow into human minds during their sleep. Detailed info about the backstory and concept can be found at: www.geniusrockopera.com

This episode refers to an aspect of the story: the toy planets. These toy planets contain secret places where all the toy fantasies are stored, ready to be used for the creation of childrens' dreams. There are many of these toys planets all around this alternative world of dreams, and Genius will have to runs through eight of these in this third game episode: "Into The Toy Planets".

This third episode runs through eight different toy planets, each divided into 10 level of increasing difficulty, for a grand total of 80 levels. All eight planets also increase in difficulty in terms of enemies and playability. Genius will need to find the right key sequence to unlock the chamber doors and grab all of the toys.

Each level has a target toy room, which is the biggest one, with bigger doors that contain the final target toy that lets Genius advance to the next level. The player's final goal is to find and free the little prince, who is imprisoned in the target toy room of level 80, on the Kokeshi toy planet.

CONTROL OF MOVEMENT

The game can be played with either keyboard or joystick, here's a list of Genius movement keys:

I/A/Q: UP

J: LEFT

K: RIGHT

M/Z/W/,/? : DOWN

ARROWS: ARROW DIRECTION

VARIOUS KEY FUNCTIONS

SPACE : Start a new game or resume a suspended game (play with keyboard)

J: Start or resume a game (play with joystick)

ESCAPE: Pause the game

Any motion keys, joystick move or SPACE: Resume a paused game

Ctrl-S: Sound ON

Ctrl-D: Sound OFF

Ctrl-W: Change the color of openable doors to White

Ctrl-G: Change the color of openable doors to Green

Ctrl-P: Suspend the game

Ctrl-Q: Quits the game

KEYSEQUENCES LIST

The game is divided in 8 different key sequences of 10 levels each:

KS1 Lvl's 1 - 10 APIKOR TOY PLANET

KS2 Lvl's 11 - 20 JERAMUS TOY PLANET

KS3 Lvl's 21 - 30 NIKO TOY PLANET

KS4 Lvl's 31 - 40 ODDYFER TOY PLANET

KS5 Lvl's 41 - 50 KLEPSYDRA TOY PLANET

KS6 Lvl's 51 - 60 WILD TRIBE TOY PLANET

KS7 Lvl's 61 - 70 MAINDREAM TOY PLANET

KS8 Lvl's 71 - 80 MC CHAOS TOY PLANET

LEVEL GAMEPLAY

Each of the 10 levels within each planet has an increasing difficulty due to an increasing number of keys and doors to unlock, increasing number of enemies and various difficulty. You advance to the next level when you grab the final target toy, placed in the big target room.

To get the the final target toy you must open all of the other doors and catch all of the keys, following the sequence. The first key is placed on top of the target room, you should start from there. For the first 40 levels, catching a key highlights the door associated with that key, making it easy to find. From level 41 onwards, this help won't be there, and you'll have to guess (and hopefully remember for the next level) the associated door.

While collecting keys and opening doors, you can collect toys for points, while avoiding killer enemies that float around the level. As you progress to higher key sequences, you will encounter toys worth more points, but also deadlier enemies.

At the highest levels of each key sequence, you may find bonus lives within the target room. Be careful to catch the bonus life before catching the target toy for that level. You must be quick! Each level has a maximum time limit, which increases with the number of doors that have to be opened and the level difficulty. When your time is up, one life is taken and your score is reset back for that level.

Note that even if you gain a life during the level (by finding the bonus life), this won't be counted at restart. This prevents you from gaining infinite points by simply catching the

bonus life and letting the timer run out. Note also that there is a slight delay between taking the final target toy and the level advance. During this delay, time continues to tick and enemies are still deadly.

POINTS SCORING

Genius collects points by catching the small toys, the final target toys in the target room, the keys and the jolly objects (except the HOURGLASS and PADLOCK).

The time remaining when a level is completed is transformed into points, so the faster you complete the level, the more points you earn.

At the end of the game, lives left are turned in bonus points. Each key sequence has different toys with increasing point values.

TOYS

Here's the full list of toys objects with their score for each of the 8 key sequences:

				100 pts					150 pts
				100 pts					150 pts
				150 pts					250 pts
				150 pts					250 pts
				250 pts					500 pts
				250 pts					500 pts
				500 pts					1000 pts
				500 pts					1000 pts

KILLER ENEMIES

There are two types of killer enemies, small ones that are trapped in the rooms and escape when you open them, and big ones that runs left and right on top of the target room. These big enemies can be stationary for a while and then suddenly wake up and randomly move to the left or right.



JOLLY OBJECTS

In the higher difficulty levels of each key sequence, jolly objects can appear above the target room. They stay for a while and then disappear, so hurry if you want to catch them.

There are four jolly objects:

DETONATOR: Destroys all small killer enemies currently active on the level

BIGKEY: Unlock all locked doors, making them all openable without having to catch keys

HOURLASS: Gives you extra bonus time to complete the level.

PADLOCK: This is a particular jolly object. When it appears in never disappears unless you catch it. If the padlock is caught all doors are re-locked and all keys are restored, so you have to start the key sequence from the beginning. This might be a way to earn more points, especially in combination with the big key jolly object, but you have to deal with the timer and make your choice carefully!



DETONATOR 2500 pts



BIGKEY 2500 pts



PADLOCK



HOURLASS

BONUS POINTS

When you complete a level, every second of time left is converted to 100 points. At the end of level 80, every life that you have remaining is worth an extra 100 points. So the faster you remember the key sequence and the more seconds you save, the more points you'll collect!

GAME SUSPENSION AND RESUME

It is possible to save the game state at any time by pressing Ctrl+P. When the game is suspended, your score, lives left, and current game state is saved relative to the BEGINNING of your current level.

It is suggested that you complete a level and then save the game when you are at the beginning of the next level. When you press Ctrl+P, please allow time for the game to save to disk. When you are back at the main logo page, you can then safely turn off your computer.

GAME SECRETS

Like many arcade games, Genius is filled with secret features to discover along the way, including invisible toys, bonus lives, immortality and many more!

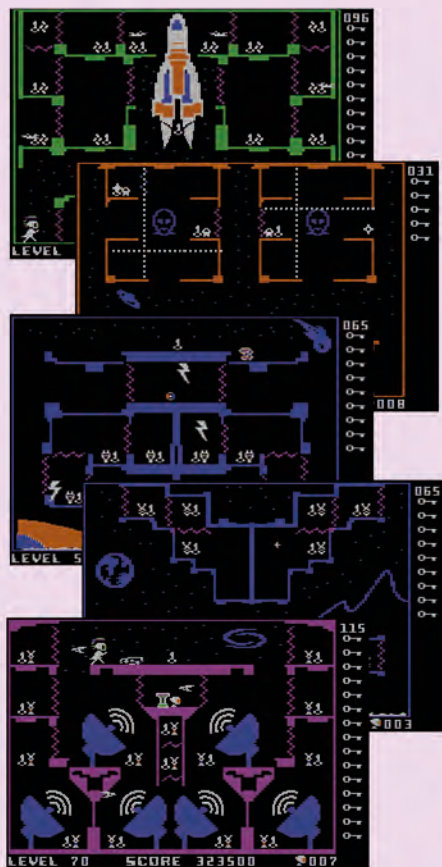
SPECIAL THANKS to the "Little Prince" and to all retrocomputing friends from all around the world who have been supporting me in many ways, including hardware support, precious programming advices, beta testing and promotion.

An extra special thanks to all Apple II lovers who will give GENIUS a try!

genius

Into the toy planets 3

by Daniele Liverani



Genius is back! The little European prince is back in trouble and needs to be saved. Trapped in a world of dreams, a parallel dimension where fantasies are created and transmitted to sleeping minds, Genius needs to run through the eight magic toy planets from all around the universe. As Genius, you'll have to follow the key sequences and unlock all the secret chambers of the toy planets, grab the toys, and avoid killer enemies. Your goal is to get to the last planet where the little European Prince is imprisoned, and save him from his sad fate of being used for a child's fantasy creation and then destroyed. Inspired by Daniele Liverani's rock opera GENIUS, the game will lead you through a magic dream factory in a parallel dimension discovered by the young drummer Genius. For a complete backstory concept of the Genius saga please visit www.geniusrockopera.com. To add fun to the ride, see if you can discover the undocumented secrets, including secret passages, invisible toys, extra bonus lives, immortality, and much more! Will you be able to save the little Prince in time?

Minimum requirements:

Apple II+ with 48K, DOS 3.3. A joystick is optional but recommended.



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